

### Psych Checkpoints - Antidepressants

| Category | Medication   | Clinical Pearls                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Black Box Warnings                                                                     | Psych C&L Management                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| SSRIs    | Citalopram   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Max dose: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ 40 mg for adults under 60</li> <li>○ 20 mg for adults over 60</li> </ul> </li> <li>• Comes in tablets and an oral solution (10 mg/5 mL)</li> </ul>                                           | Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in pediatric and young adult patients | Labs/Diagnostics: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• Serum sodium</li> <li>• CBC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|          | Escitalopram | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Generally well tolerated, fewer drug interactions</li> <li>• QTc prolongation - less likely than citalopram</li> <li>• Comes in tablets and an oral solution (5 mg/5 mL)</li> </ul>                                                                                         |                                                                                        | Labs/Diagnostics: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• Serum sodium</li> <li>• CBC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|          | Fluoxetine   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Long half life (1-3 days, metabolite can hang around for 4-16 days)</li> <li>• Lots of drug interactions (do an interaction check)</li> <li>• Activating - dose in the morning if possible</li> <li>• Comes in capsules, tablets, and oral solution (20 mg/5 mL)</li> </ul> |                                                                                        | Check drug interactions<br>Labs/Diagnostics: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Serum sodium</li> <li>• CBC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|          | Fluvoxamine  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Only FDA indicated for OCD</li> <li>• Avoid if patient is on warfarin (due to 2C9 activity increasing the concentration of warfarin)</li> <li>• Highest incidence of nausea, drowsiness, insomnia, and headache</li> <li>• Comes in tablets and ER capsules</li> </ul>      |                                                                                        | Labs/Diagnostics: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Serum sodium</li> <li>• CBC</li> </ul> Avoid if patient is on warfarin (due to 2C9 activity increasing the concentration of warfarin)                                                                                                                         |
|          | Paroxetine   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Discontinuation syndrome</li> <li>• Drug interactions</li> <li>• Renal and hepatic dose adjustments</li> <li>• Comes in capsules, suspension (10 mg/5 mL), tablets, and ER tablets</li> <li>• Anticholinergic/sedating</li> </ul>                                           |                                                                                        | Avoid starting if possible (lots of drug interactions, discontinuation syndrome) <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• If patient is already on it: check drug interactions, ensure medication adherence</li> </ul> Labs/Diagnostics: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Serum sodium</li> <li>• CBC</li> </ul> |

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|                               | Sertraline      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• GI side effects most prominent</li> <li>• Safest in cardiac disease (SADHART and SADHART-CHF - safe in patients with significant HF and after ACS)</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                        | Labs/Diagnostics: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Serum sodium</li> <li>• CBC</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                  |
| SNRIs                         | Desvenlafaxine  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• \$\$\$</li> <li>• Renal dose adjustments needed</li> <li>• Comes only as ER tablets</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• No proven benefit above 50 mg</li> <li>• Expensive, other options better.</li> </ul>                                                                                                      |
|                               | Duloxetine      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Renal and hepatic dose adjustments</li> <li>• Several FDA indications <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Generalized anxiety disorder</li> <li>○ Major depressive disorder</li> <li>○ Fibromyalgia</li> <li>○ Musculoskeletal pain</li> <li>○ Neuropathic pain associated with diabetes</li> </ul> </li> </ul>                                                                                                      |                                                                                        | Smoking history - consider decrease dose inpatient or monitor side effects                                                                                                                                                         |
|                               | Levomilnacipran | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Renal dose adjustments</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                        | Labs: SCr                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|                               | Milnacipran     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Only approved for fibromyalgia</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Only approved for fibromyalgia</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                 |
|                               | Venlafaxine     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Discontinuation syndrome - confirm if patient is on IR or ER formulations at home (IR should be dosed 2-3 times daily)</li> <li>• Renal and hepatic dose adjustments</li> <li>• Comes in ER capsules, ER tablets and IR tablets</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                        | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Blood pressure</li> <li>• QTc</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                            |
| Miscellaneous Antidepressants | Bupropion       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Weak inhibitor of the uptake of norepinephrine and dopamine - does not inhibit MAO or serotonin</li> <li>• Very few sexual side effects</li> <li>• Activating medication - dose in the morning</li> <li>• Avoid in patients with bulimia or anorexia nervosa due to elevated risk of seizures</li> <li>• Can be used for smoking cessation (Zyban ®)</li> <li>• Comes as IR tablets, SR tablets and XL tablets</li> </ul> | Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in pediatric and young adult patients | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Do not exceed doses of 450 mg per day to avoid seizures</li> <li>• Do not titrate up rapidly</li> <li>• Patient history - do they have a history of seizures? Eating disorder?</li> </ul> |
|                               | Mirtazapine     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Antagonist of serotonin receptors and histamine receptors</li> <li>• Moderate peripheral alpha-adrenergic and muscarinic</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in                                    | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• SCr</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                      |

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|                           |               | antagonist <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Does not inhibit reuptake of norepinephrine or serotonin</li> <li>Use in caution with hepatic and renal impairment</li> <li>Comes as tablets and ODTs</li> </ul>                                                                                                        | pediatric and young adult patients                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>LFTs</li> <li>Weight</li> </ul>                             |
| Serotonin Modulators      | Nefazodone    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>BBW: life-threatening hepatic failure</li> <li>Less sexual side effects</li> <li>No renal adjustments</li> <li>Comes only as tablets</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                    | Life-threatening hepatic failure<br><br>Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in pediatric and young adult patients | Labs: LFTs<br>Risk of SI?                                                                          |
|                           | Trazodone     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>GI side effects (10-15% - increases with increased dose)</li> <li>Dizziness - 20-28%, drowsiness - 24-41%, fatigue - 6-11%, headache - 10-20%, nervousness - 15%</li> <li>Can cause priapism</li> <li>No renal or hepatic adjustments studied</li> <li>Comes as tablets</li> </ul> | Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in pediatric and young adult patients                                         | Mostly used for sleep instead of depression due to orthostasis<br>History of priapism?             |
|                           | Vilazodone    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>SSRI + Serotonin receptor partial agonist</li> <li>Expensive - only brand name</li> <li>No renal or hepatic adjustments</li> <li>Only comes as tablets</li> </ul>                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                | \$\$\$                                                                                             |
|                           | Vortioxetine  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Expensive - only brand name</li> <li>No renal or hepatic adjustments</li> <li>Only comes as tablets</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                | \$\$\$                                                                                             |
| Tricyclic Antidepressants | Amitriptyline | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Fall risk - use with caution in elderly patients</li> <li>Renally eliminated, hepatically metabolized - use with caution in renal and hepatic impairment</li> <li>Drug interactions</li> <li>Comes only as tablets</li> </ul>                                                      | Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in pediatric and young adult patients                                         | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>SCr</li> <li>QTc</li> <li>LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI? |
|                           | Amoxapine     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Rarely used</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                | Labs:                                                                                              |

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|  |               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Renally eliminated, hepatically metabolized - use with caution in renal and hepatic impairment</li> <li>• Comes only as tablets</li> </ul>                      |  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• SCr</li> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?       |
|  | Clomipramine  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Approved for OCD only</li> <li>• Hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>• Comes only as capsules</li> </ul>                                                                    |  | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?                |
|  | Desipramine   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Smoking impacts dose</li> <li>• Hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>• Comes only as tablets</li> </ul>                                          |  | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?                |
|  | Doxepin       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Smoking impacts dose</li> <li>• Hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>• Comes as capsules, concentration (10 mg/mL), and tablets</li> </ul>       |  | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?                |
|  | Imipramine    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Smoking impacts dose</li> <li>• Hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>• Comes as capsules and tablets</li> </ul>                                  |  | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?                |
|  | Nortriptyline | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Smoking impacts dose</li> <li>• Renally eliminated, hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>• Come as capsules and solution (10 mg/5 mL)</li> </ul> |  | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• SCr</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI? |
|  | Protriptyline | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Rarely used</li> <li>• QTc prolongation</li> <li>• Hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>• Comes as tablets</li> </ul>                                                        |  | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• QTc</li> <li>• LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?                |

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|       | Trimipramine    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Rarely used</li> <li>● QTc prolongation</li> <li>● Hepatically metabolized - use with caution</li> <li>● Comes as capsules</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                 | Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● QTc</li> <li>● LFTs</li> </ul> Risk of SI?                                                                                                                                                                   |
| MAOIs | Isocarboxazid   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● DRUG INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● FOOD INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● Avoid tyramine containing foods <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Hypertensive crisis</li> </ul> </li> <li>● Contraindicated in patients with renal or hepatic impairment</li> <li>● Comes as tablets</li> </ul>                          | Increased risk of suicidal thoughts and behavior in pediatric and young adult patients<br><br>Hypertensive crisis with significant tyramine use | Food and drug interactions<br>Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● SCr</li> <li>● LFTs</li> </ul> Washout period!                                                                                                                                 |
|       | Phenelzine      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● DRUG INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● FOOD INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● Avoid tyramine containing foods <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Hypertensive crisis</li> </ul> </li> <li>● Contraindicated in patients with renal or hepatic impairment</li> <li>● Comes as tablets</li> </ul>                          |                                                                                                                                                 | Food and drug interactions<br>Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● SCr</li> <li>● LFTs</li> </ul> Washout period!                                                                                                                                 |
|       | Selegiline      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● DRUG INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● FOOD INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● Avoid tyramine containing foods <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Hypertensive crisis</li> </ul> </li> <li>● Contraindicated in patients with renal or hepatic impairment</li> <li>● Comes as tablets, capsules, ODTs, patches</li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                                 | Food and drug interactions <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● Except 6 mg patch</li> <li>● If higher dose patch, watch for food interactions</li> </ul> Labs: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● SCr</li> <li>● LFTs</li> </ul> Washout period! |
|       | Tranylcypromine | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● DRUG INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● FOOD INTERACTIONS</li> <li>● Avoid tyramine containing foods <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Hypertensive crisis</li> </ul> </li> <li>● No renal or hepatic adjustments</li> <li>● Comes as tablets</li> </ul>                                                       |                                                                                                                                                 | Food and drug interactions<br>Washout period!                                                                                                                                                                                                               |